■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, October 19, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (6 stories)

■■ *'RHONY' star Carole Radziwill shares surprising news after The Post's parking scam exposé*

The Angle: *A 'Real Housewives' alum getting caught gaming the system with a bogus fire department placard is pure reality-TV irony — and the $8,000 unpaid tab makes it even juicier.*

- **Carole Radziwill**, former **RHONY** star, racked up roughly **$8,000** in traffic violations since **2020**
- She allegedly used an **expired FDNY placard** in her windshield to dodge parking enforcement
- Among the violations: **17 tickets** for missing alternate side street cleaning
- The scam was exposed by **The New York Post**

The Hypocrisy Hook

- She played a 'real' housewife on TV — does getting busted faking an FDNY pass make her more relatable or just more busted?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/19/us-news/rhony-star-carole-radziwill-shares-surprising-news-after-the-posts-parking-scam-expose/

■ *Kylie Jenner models $50 million Fantasy Bra at Victoria's Secret Show - USA Today*

The Angle: *The Victoria's Secret Fashion Show finally brought back its iconic Fantasy Bra, and Kylie Jenner was the one chosen to wear $50 million in diamonds on a runway — that's a celebrity-meets-spectacle combo that's pure watercooler fodder.*

- **Kylie Jenner** wore the historic **Fantasy Bra** during the **Victoria's Secret Fashion Show** on **Sunday, Oct. 18**
- The bra is valued at a jaw-dropping **$50 million**
- It's famously known as **Victoria's Secret's crown jewel** and the "world's dreamiest bra"
- Its runway return was treated as a surprise moment for the crowd

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather wear $50 million in diamonds for ten minutes or just take the cash?

USA Today (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.usatoday.com/story/entertainment/style/2026/10/18/kylie-jenner-victorias-secret-fashion-show-2026-fantasy-bra/92266856007/

❤■ *15 year old Ethan from Nottinghamshire performed up to 800 chest compressions in six minutes, helping save a neighbour who was unconscious and not breathing. The patient is now recovering, and he hopes to launch community CPR workshops to teach others how to save lives.*

The Angle: *A 15-year-old kid became a real-life hero in six minutes flat — and now he wants to turn it into a community CPR program. It's the kind of good-news story that makes you want to actually learn CPR yourself.*

- **Ethan**, 15, from **Nottinghamshire**, found a neighbour unconscious and not breathing
- He performed up to **800 chest compressions** in just **six minutes** to keep them alive
- The neighbour is now **recovering**

- Ethan's next move: launching **community CPR workshops** to teach others how to do what he did

The Feel-Good Gut Check

- Be honest — if someone collapsed in front of you right now, would YOU know what to do?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nottinghampost.com/news/local-news/nottinghamshire-student-facing-nightmare-scenario-11203593

■ *Meta says it shut No Kings account because it suspected bots activity*

The Angle: *A Big Tech platform shutting down the account behind a nationwide protest movement is instant conflict — free speech vs. bot-cleanup, and it's blowing up on r/technology right now.*

- **Meta** says it shut down the **'No Kings'** account over suspected **bot activity**.
- **'No Kings'** is the name tied to the wave of large anti-Trump protests seen across the US.
- Exact platform, scale, and timeline of the takedown haven't been detailed yet.

The Debate Starter

- Is this Meta cleaning up real bots, or Big Tech quietly burying a protest movement?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/meta-says-suspending-no-kings-account-was-done-in-error-2026-10

■ *Big Tech Will Not Broadcast Your Dissent*

The Angle: *This taps into the ongoing national fight over content moderation and free speech online — a debate that resurfaces every few weeks and always gets people fired up about who controls what you see and say.*

The Debate Starter

- Have you ever felt your own post or video got buried for saying something unpopular — call in and tell us.

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.motherjones.com/politics/2026/10/meta-x-no-kings-elections-protests-midterms-free-speech-us-brazil/

■ *As the coding boom fades, computer science grads focus on AI skills in choppy job market*

The Angle: *Computer science used to be THE guaranteed-job degree, but new grads are hitting a wall as the coding boom cools - now they're scrambling to bolt on AI skills just to stay competitive, which says a lot about how fast this industry is moving under everyone's feet.*

The Debate Starter

- Would you still tell a kid today to major in computer science?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/ai-computer-science-jobs-college-degree-99416cc8981d701e3674cf3dfa501491

Backup options:

■ *Landmark China trial gets 84% efficacy in treating cancer with cue from waste water tech*

The Angle: *A landmark Chinese clinical trial is reportedly using a method borrowed from wastewater treatment tech to fight cancer with striking results — the kind of 'science is wild' story that gets people talking about how breakthroughs come from the strangest places.*

- A **landmark clinical trial in China** is being reported with an **84% efficacy rate** treating cancer
- The approach reportedly takes its cue from **wastewater treatment technology** — not a typical medical starting point
- Story is circulating out of **r/futurology**, early buzz stage with limited detail so far

The Science Debate

- If the cure for cancer is hiding in sewage tech, what other 'gross' industries might be sitting on the next big breakthrough?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.scmp.com/news/china/science/article/3370996/landmark-china-trial-gets-84-efficacy-treating-cancer-clue-waste-water-tech?utm_source=Reddit&utm_medium=Social

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■ *One-quarter of the world's data centers are located in areas where water demand exceeds supply for at least one month each year. Unlike energy, which can come from far away, water for these facilities comes from nearby rivers, lakes, and aquifers whose levels vary seasonally or annually.*

The Angle: *Everyone's obsessing over how much power AI data centers burn, but almost nobody's talking about the water — and it turns out these facilities can't just truck it in from somewhere else like they can electricity.*

- **One-quarter** of the world's data centers sit in regions where water demand already outstrips supply for **at least one month every year**.
- Unlike power, which can be piped in from a grid far away, data center water has to come from **nearby rivers, lakes, and aquifers**.
- Those local water sources rise and fall with the seasons — so a facility can be fine in spring and bone-dry by summer.

The Debate Starter

- Should your city get a say before a massive data center moves in and starts competing with your tap water?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.acs.org/pressroom/presspacs/2026/october/many-data-centers-are-located-where-water-resources-are-limited.html

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■ *Alberta Separatists confident of victory due to "Canadians' overwhelming love for USA and Trump"*

The Angle: *Alberta's separatist movement is feeling bold, and their reasoning is the real story — they're claiming Canadians secretly love the U.S. and Donald Trump, a take that flies in the face of the current chill in U.S.-Canada relations.*

- **Alberta separatists** say they're confident of winning support — pointing to what they call Canadians' "**overwhelming love**" for the **U.S.** and **Donald Trump**.
- The claim lands during a noticeably rocky stretch for **U.S.-Canada relations**, with cross-border tension running high under **Trump**.
- The take is blowing up on **r/canada**, with commenters firing back that it badly misreads how Canadians actually feel.

The Debate Starter

- Do Canadians secretly love Trump — or are the separatists completely out of touch?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/10/alberta-separatists-confident-of-victory-due-to-canadians-overwhelming-love-for-usa-and-trump/

■■ *Jon Stewart to stay at 'The Daily Show' through the 2028 election*

The Angle: *Stewart just committed to riding out an entire presidential cycle behind the Daily Show desk, which matters because he's arguably the most trusted political voice in late night — this is him betting the next three years of American politics are going to need him.*

- **Jon Stewart** has agreed to stay at **'The Daily Show'** through the **2028 election**
- He returned to the anchor desk after years away, now hosting on a part-time weekly basis
- The move signals the show is building its election coverage plans around him specifically

The Debate Starter

- Is Jon Stewart still the sharpest voice in political comedy, or is he coasting on nostalgia at this point?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cnn.com/2026/10/19/media/jon-stewart-daily-show-2028-skydance-comedy-central?utm_medium=social&utm_campaign=missions&utm_source=reddit

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CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

■ *Toronto man accused of driving rental car 30,000 kms in just 7 days*

The Angle: *That's basically driving across Canada and back multiple times in seven days - the math alone makes this a classic 'wait, how is that even possible' water cooler story.*

- A **Toronto man** is accused of racking up **30,000 kilometres** on a rental car in just **7 days**.
- That works out to roughly **4,285 km per day** - like driving from **Toronto to Vancouver** and back, more than once, every single day.
- Story originated on **Reddit's r/nottheonion**, flagged for its sheer 'is this even real' factor.

The Math Check

- Call in: what's the longest road trip you've ever crammed into a week, and did your car survive it?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://toronto.citynews.ca/2026/10/19/toronto-man-rental-car-30-thousand-kms-avis-seven-days/

■ *Norwegian undersea cable builder pitches 2,800-mile transatlantic data link between Canada and Europe to bypass the U.S — Canadian majority partner sought to help fund and build new $620 million fiber connection to reduce reliance on American routes*

The Angle: *A Norwegian company wants to build a brand-new undersea internet cable straight from Canada to Europe — no U.S. detour required — and it's shopping for a Canadian partner to help pay for it. With all the 'reduce reliance on America' talk lately, this feels like that sentiment showing up in literal infrastructure.*

- The proposed cable would stretch **2,800 miles**, running directly between **Canada and Europe**
- Price tag for the project: **$620 million**
- The pitch comes from a **Norwegian** undersea cable builder
- They're looking for a **Canadian majority partner** to help fund and construct it, specifically to cut dependence on U.S.-routed internet traffic

The Sovereignty Angle

- Should Canada be spending big to make sure its internet doesn't have to run through America?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/data-centers/norwegian-undersea-cable-builder-pitches-2-800-mile-transatlantic-data-link-between-canada-and-europe-to-bypass-the-us-canadian-majority-partner-sought-to-help-fund-and-build-new-usd620-million-fiber-connection-to-reduce-reliance-on-american-routes

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■ *Norwegian Company Pitches 2,800-Mile Undersea Cable Linking Canada and Europe to Bypass the US*

The Angle: *A Norwegian firm is pitching a 2,800-mile undersea cable connecting Canada directly to Europe, deliberately routing around the United States — a literal infrastructure project born out of wanting to cut America out of the loop.*

- The proposed cable would run roughly **2,800 miles**, linking **Canada** straight to **Europe**.
- It's being pitched by a **Norwegian company**.
- The whole point of the route is to **bypass the United States** entirely.

The Debate Starter

- Is this just smart data infrastructure, or a sign allies are starting to route around the US on purpose?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://finance.yahoo.com/technology/articles/norwegian-company-pitches-2-800-175614209.html

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■ *Rising use of AI-staged real estate photos raises questions about misleading homebuyers*

The Angle: *AI tools can now digitally stage, repaint, or even redesign a house in listing photos before a buyer ever walks in - raising the question of where "staging" ends and "false advertising" begins for Canadian homebuyers.*

The Debate Starter

- Ever shown up to a house that looked nothing like its listing pics - should realtors have to disclose when photos are AI-touched?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/rising-use-of-ai-staged-real-estate-photos-raises-questions-about-misleading-homebuyers-9.7382211

Backup options:

■■ *Americans Are Meddling in the Alberta Referendum*

The Angle: *A Canadian provincial referendum on independence getting outside American interference raises real sovereignty questions - it's the kind of cross-border political story that gets both Canadian and US listeners talking about where the line is on foreign influence.*

- The claim at the center of this: **American** interests are allegedly weighing in on **Alberta's** independence referendum.
- It taps into the broader, ongoing **Alberta sovereignty** debate and its friction with the federal government in **Ottawa**.
- Foreign involvement in a provincial vote - even alleged - is the kind of thing that raises eyebrows on both sides of the border.

The Debate Starter

- Should outsiders - even just opinionated neighbors to the south - have any say in how a Canadian province decides its own future?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://macleans.ca/politics/americans-are-meddling-in-the-alberta-referendum/

■ *Prime Minister of The Netherlands, Rob Jetten, and Argentinian field hockey player, Nicolas Keenan, are expecting their first child.*

The Angle: *The Dutch Prime Minister and his partner, an Argentine Olympic field hockey player, just announced they're expecting their first baby — a feel-good political crossover story with real international reach.*

- **Rob Jetten**, Prime Minister of **The Netherlands**, and his partner **Nicolas Keenan**, an Argentine field hockey player, are expecting their first child together.
- The news made the rounds via **r/fauxmoi**, signaling it's already crossing over into pop-culture chatter, not just political press.

The Feel-Good Angle

- A sitting head of government starting a family in office is rare, wholesome news — worth a quick "good for them" moment on air.

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1x9xp79

■■ *Canada-wide support grows for CFB Wainwright victims as 50 investigators probe deadly fire*

The Angle: *A deadly fire at Canadian Forces Base Wainwright has triggered a massive investigation and a wave of nationwide support — the kind of story that cuts through because it hits a military community, and Canadians love to rally behind the Forces.*

- The fire broke out at **CFB Wainwright**, a major Canadian Forces base in Alberta.
- **50 investigators** are now working the scene to figure out what caused it.
- Support for the victims is reportedly pouring in from **across the country**, not just the local area.

The Community Pulse

- When something hits a military base like this, the whole country tends to feel it — ask listeners if they've got ties to CFB Wainwright or know someone affected.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/livestory/cfb-wainwright-fire-deaths-carney-9.7386478?cmp=rss

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■ *Canadian who stole a Las Vegas flamingo after drinking '30 to 40' beers convicted of animal cruelty*

The Angle: *A Canadian guy got convicted of animal cruelty in Vegas after swiping a hotel's living mascot bird on a bender — it's the kind of absurd, so-dumb-it's-funny crime story that's tailor-made for Canadian News banter.*

- **Mitchell Fairbarn**, a man from **Ontario**, was convicted of animal cruelty charges in a Las Vegas court on **Monday**.
- He snatched a flamingo named **Peachy** right out of its habitat at the **Flamingo Las Vegas Hotel and Casino**.
- The incident happened last **March**.
- Fairbarn told authorities he'd had **"30 to 40" beers**; prosecutors called the theft a **"drunken and malicious act."**

The Debate Starter

- Thirty to forty beers — is that even physically possible, or is this guy just taking the fall for the whole country's reputation?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/canadian-flamingo-las-vegas-9.7386697?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■ *Dylan Sprouse Praises New Mom Barbara Palvin for Walking the 2026 Victoria’s Secret Fashion Show - People.com*

The Angle: *Dylan Sprouse Praises New Mom Barbara Palvin for Walking the 2026 Victoria’s Secret Fashion Show - People.com*

PEOPLE (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://people.com/dylan-sprouse-praises-wife-barbara-palvin-for-walking-2026-victorias-secret-fashion-show-after-giving-birth-12181008

■ *All the Stars at the 2026 Victoria’s Secret Fashion Show: Nicole Kidman, Law Roach & More - Vogue*

The Angle: *The Victoria's Secret Fashion Show is making its splashy comeback tonight in Culver City, and the red carpet is pulling in A-list names like Nicole Kidman alongside stylist Law Roach — perfect watercooler fodder for who showed up and who wore it best.*

- Tonight's show kicks off at **Sony Studios** in **Culver City, California**.
- **Nicole Kidman** is among the stars walking the red carpet.
- Stylist **Law Roach** also made an appearance on the carpet.
- The brand's **Angels** hit the runway in Victoria's Secret's biggest looks.

The Best-Dressed Debate

- Callers — who actually served tonight, Kidman or the Angels?

Vogue (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.vogue.com/slideshow/victorias-secret-fashion-show-red-carpet-10-18-2026

■ *Bari Weiss Exposed for Pushing CBS to Smear Democratic Candidates*

The Angle: *This is blowing up on Reddit as a 'gotcha' claim against Bari Weiss, a media figure who's already a lightning rod for bias accusations from both sides - that alone makes it a juicy watercooler topic even before anyone confirms the details.*

The Debate Starter

- Bombshell scoop or partisan pile-on dressed up as journalism - which is this?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://newrepublic.com/post/216774/bari-weiss-cbs-smear-democratic-candidates-talarico-el-sayed

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■ *Bono hits out at "unconscionable" Elon Musk*

The Angle: *A rock legend taking a direct shot at the world's richest man is instant celebrity-feud gold, and it taps into the bigger ongoing debate about Musk's influence and behavior.*

The Debate Starter

- Is Bono right to call out Musk, or should musicians stay out of billionaire beef?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://faroutmagazine.co.uk/bono-hits-out-elon-musk-unconscionable-doge-cuts/

■ *A protester standing directly behind Vance stood up and shouted, "Release the Epstein files!" during a political rally in Hendersonville.*

The Angle: *A protester popping up right behind a sitting VP mid-rally is the kind of split-second viral moment that's made for clips and reaction threads, and the Epstein files chant keeps that story alive in pop culture even when the news cycle moves on.*

- A protester positioned **directly behind Vance** on stage during the rally.
- They stood up and shouted, **"Release the Epstein files!"**
- The moment happened at a political rally in **Hendersonville**.
- Story is circulating via **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, where it's being treated as a viral clip-worthy moment.

The Debate Starter

- Is heckling a sitting VP mid-speech a legit protest tactic or just a stunt for the clip?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/9vbtct75hhwh1

Backup options:

■ *Israeli television personality Lior Schleien has to explain to 17 year-old Tel Aviv high school students why killing everyone in Palestine is bad*

The Angle: *A viral clip of Israeli TV personality **Lior Schleien** fielding - and having to argue against - a question from **Tel Aviv high schoolers** about wiping out Palestine is blowing up for what it reveals about where some young people's heads are at right now.*

- **Lior Schleien**, an Israeli TV personality, is the one put in the position of having to make the case
- The students in question are **17-year-olds** at a **Tel Aviv high school**
- Clip is circulating on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, framed around the sheer fact that this conversation had to happen at all

The Debate Starter

- Should it really take a TV host to explain basic morality to a room full of teenagers?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/jlih1hgt6gwh1

■ *'You Can See Everything' sells out theatres, and people can't stop talking about it*

The Angle: *There's a new movie everyone's buzzing about but refusing to spill details on, and that secrecy is exactly what's driving sold-out crowds to see it for themselves.*

- **'You Can See Everything'** is selling out theatres right now
- It's pulling in big numbers at the box office
- The twist: fans are talking about it nonstop but actively avoiding spoilers

The Debate Starter

- Are you Team No-Spoilers-Ever, or Team Just-Tell-Me-So-I-Can-Decide?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/you-can-see-everything-box-office-9.7386841?cmp=rss

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■ *Homer-happy Rays finish off Guardians to set up small-market World Series matchup with Brewers*

The Angle: *The Tampa Bay Rays are headed to just their third World Series ever, and they're doing it against another small-market underdog in the Brewers — a matchup that's got baseball purists buzzing about two scrappy front offices outsmarting the big spenders.*

- **Rays** beat the **Guardians 7-3** in **Game 6 of the ALCS** at **Tropicana Field**
- It's Tampa Bay's **third World Series appearance** in franchise history
- Their last trip was back in **2020**
- They'll face the **Brewers** in an all-small-market **Fall Classic**

The Underdog Debate

- Small-market World Series, no superstar-stacked lineups — is this the most lovable Fall Classic in years, or a ratings nightmare for baseball?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/19/sports/rays-finish-off-guardians-to-set-up-world-series-matchup-with-brewers/

■ *God’s Love We Deliver Golden Heart Awards 2026 red carpet: Olivia Munn, Paige DeSorbo, Nicky Hilton and more*

The Angle: *A star-studded red carpet moment for a good cause — these are the names you follow on Instagram, now all in one room for charity, which is prime gossip-and-fashion fodder.*

- **Olivia Munn** stepped out for the **God's Love We Deliver Golden Heart Awards 2026**
- **Paige DeSorbo** and **Nicky Hilton** also hit the red carpet to support the cause
- The event benefits **God's Love We Deliver**, a charity organization

The Style Chat

- Who do you think brought the best red carpet look — Munn, DeSorbo, or Hilton?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/19/photos/gods-love-we-deliver-golden-heart-awards-2026-red-carpet-olivia-munn-paige-desorbo-nicky-hilton-and-more/

■ *Jesse Eisenberg Says He ‘Couldn’t Get Movie Studio Parts Anymore’ After Winning A Razzie For ‘Batman v Superman’: ‘The Industry Did Not Want Me to Be in a Superhero Movie’ - Variety*

The Angle: *A legit Hollywood star saying an infamous flop and a Razzie win tanked his studio career for years is the kind of insider confession audiences eat up — it's gossip with real stakes about how brutal the industry*

actually is.

- **Jesse Eisenberg** played **Lex Luthor** in **Zack Snyder's** "**Batman v Superman: Dawn of Justice**"
- He won a **Razzie (Golden Raspberry Award)** for the role
- Eisenberg says he **"couldn't get movie studio parts anymore"** after the loss
- His quote: **"The industry did not want me to be in a superhero movie"**

The Debate Starter

- Is it fair that one bad superhero role can quietly end an actor's studio career?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/global/jesse-eisenberg-razzie-batman-v-superman-1236915876/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Indiana Democrat Jaime West reveals how many beers she downed before trainwreck interview*

The Angle: *A county council candidate's slurring, rambling local interview blew up online — and instead of apologizing, she went on national TV to defend her drinking and her rant. That combo of booze, politics, and zero regret is pure watercooler gold.*

- **Jaime West**, a Democratic county council candidate in **Fayetteville, Indiana**, admitted she drank **"three beers"** before the interview
- The original interview went viral after she slurred through a rambling monologue
- In that rant, she pledged to **"fire all Republicans"**
- Defending herself on **"Piers Morgan Uncensored,"** she insisted she **"wasn't that intoxicated"**

The Debate Starter

- Three beers deep and vowing to fire half the government on camera — callers, what's your personal cutoff before you'd never do a live interview?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 90/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 33 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://nypost.com/2026/10/19/us-news/indiana-democrat-jaime-west-reveals-how-many-beers-she-downed-before-trainwreck-interview/

Backup options:

■ *Influencer Hit in Face by Lisa Rinna's Massive Hat Feather at Victoria's Secret Fashion Show - People.com*

The Angle: *A chaotic, only-at-fashion-week moment from the Victoria's Secret show is already a viral clip - celebrity accessory meets innocent bystander, and it's exactly the kind of silly, visual story that blows up online.*

- **Lisa Rinna** was wearing an oversized feathered hat at the **Victoria's Secret Fashion Show**.
- The hat's feather reportedly struck an influencer **right in the face**.
- The moment is being covered by **People.com** as a standout from the event.

The Debate Starter

- Is a giant runway hat worth the risk of clotheslining someone next to you - callers, what's the most ridiculous accessory you've ever seen cause chaos?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiugFBVV95cUxOSThlZTRXSnlVa2NPRUNKY1RUaFVQTFNDUDV3elZPTDdad0xnOGx3RGJEVGVONndHUU1qLUlfZ0EtOWEyb0owVXE2aTFBY1owa1BjZlFtaHhUNHdrMjkyM0VYb0dHNW5wTGVoX0tleTV1WlY2WVNpS3RZMTI3SDhGTnB1N3VHTUd5VHpoUkR0VkxUakltc19UalZvQmFKSl8tU3BYWUFVa01nd0hDbUpPSHVabjJpZEExQ2c?oc=5

■ *'The Simpsons' Surprise: Apu Is Heard for the First Time in Nearly a Decade, as Sunil Malhotra Takes Over for Hank Azaria (EXCLUSIVE) - Variety*

The Angle: *This closes the loop on one of the biggest pop-culture controversies of the last decade — Apu went silent after accent criticism, and now Springfield just brought him back with a new voice. It's a built-in nostalgia-meets-cancel-culture conversation.*

- **Apu** is heard on **'The Simpsons'** for the first time in nearly **10 years**
- The character is now voiced by **Sunil Malhotra**, replacing original voice actor **Hank Azaria**
- The reveal came in the **Oct. 18** episode titled **'The Revengening'**
- Azaria stepped away from voicing Apu in **2017** amid backlash over the character's stereotyped accent

The Debate Starter

- Was bringing Apu back the right call, or should Springfield have just left that storyline retired?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/the-simpsons-apu-new-voice-sunil-malhotra-hank-azaria-1236915177/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *New eye-tracking study finds men spend longer looking at attractive faces only if they're the sex they're attracted to, but women look longer at attractive faces of both men and women. And being in a long-term relationship didn't stop people from lingering on good-looking faces either.*

The Angle: *An eye-tracking study on attraction just gave couples a new thing to argue about at dinner - and it confirms what a lot of partners have suspected for years.*

- **Men** only lingered longer on attractive faces when it matched **who they're attracted to**
- **Women**, on the other hand, spent more time looking at attractive faces of **both men and women**
- Being in a **long-term relationship** did NOT stop people from lingering on good-looking faces

The Debate Starter

- Partners, be honest: does this study track with what you've caught your other half doing?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/womens-attention-to-beauty-isnt-limited-to-the-sex-theyre-attracted-to-eye-tracking-study-finds/

Backup options:

■ *A new study found that HSV-1, the virus that causes cold sores, can reprogram the brain's immune cells, potentially linking viral infection to chronic inflammation and increased vulnerability to Alzheimer's disease.*

The Angle: *Cold sores feel like a minor annoyance, but new research says that same virus might be quietly rewiring brain immune cells and nudging the door open for Alzheimer's — a wild 'wait, what?' story that hits almost everyone since most adults carry this virus.*

- Virus in question: **HSV-1**, the common virus behind **cold sores**
- Researchers say it can **reprogram the brain's immune cells**
- The reprogramming is linked to **chronic inflammation** in the brain
- Study ties this process to **increased vulnerability to Alzheimer's disease**

The Watercooler Freakout

- Raise your hand if you've ever had a cold sore — because this study just made that a brain story, not a lip story.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.cuanschutz.edu/news-stories/common-cold-sore-virus-may-reprogram-the-brains-immune-defenses?utm_campaign=HSV1_Virus&utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=social

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■ *A clinical trial has found that hydrodissection, injecting saline to separate a trapped nerve from surrounding tissue, provides carpal tunnel relief lasting up to 6 months, outperforming standard steroid injections.*

The Angle: *Anyone who types, scrolls, or works with their hands has flirted with carpal tunnel pain, and this trial suggests a simple saline injection could beat the standard steroid shot for lasting relief - that's a real watercooler health tip.*

- The technique is called **hydrodissection** - injecting **saline** to physically separate a trapped nerve from the tissue around it
- A clinical trial found relief lasting **up to 6 months**
- It reportedly **outperformed standard steroid injections**, the current go-to treatment

The Phone-In Trigger

- Who on the show or in our listener base has dealt with carpal tunnel - and would you try a saline shot over steroids or surgery?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/a-saline-injection-could-offer-longer-relief-from-carpal-tunnel-pain

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Why ‘Office Space’ Actor Richard Riehle Was the Quintessential Actor’s Actor (Guest Column)*

The Angle: *He's the guy with the stress ball in Office Space — a cult classic every office worker quotes. This is a heartfelt send-off from someone who actually worked with him, the kind of 'actor's actor' story that hits different than a standard obit.*

- **Richard Riehle** is best remembered for his role in the cult office comedy **"Office Space"**
- The tribute comes from a **Variety guest column** written by a filmmaker who cast him early in his career
- The writer recalls asking **Richard** to appear in one of his first-ever projects, a **Funny or Die video**, alongside friend **Tanner Thomason**

The Quick Toast

- Give it up for the guy with the stress ball — what's the most quotable 'that guy' character from a movie you rewatch?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 33 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/people-news/office-space-actor-richard-riehle-an-actors-actor-1236917003/

Backup options:

■ *Angelina Jolie’s foundation has protected 150,720 acres of Cambodian forest for 20 years, where elephants and pangolins still roam; its rangers removed more than 4.8 miles of illegal snares in 2025, helping keep the forest safe for wildlife.*

The Angle: *It's a feel-good wildlife win hiding in plain sight - a Hollywood A-lister quietly running conservation work for two decades while elephants and pangolins still roam free because of it.*

- **Angelina Jolie's** foundation has protected **150,720 acres** of forest in **Cambodia** for **20 years**
- The land is still home to **elephants** and **pangolins**
- Rangers pulled over **4.8 miles** of illegal snares out of the forest in **2025** alone

The Feel-Good Finish

- Twenty years of quiet work nobody was clapping for - that's the kind of celebrity story we actually like.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ecoticias.com/en/angelina-jolies-foundation-has-spent-20-years-in-a-150720-acre-cambodian-forest-where-elephants-and-pangolins-still-roam-and-its-rangers-pulled-about-4-8-miles-of-wire-snares-out-in-2025/52110/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 4/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *After 300 bison were reintroduced to Oklahoma's tallgrass prairie in 1993, the herd has grown to around 2,700 and helped restore the ecosystem, with more wildflowers, new wildlife ponds and less grassland fuel for wildfires across the 39,000 acre preserve.*

The Angle: *It's a feel-good full-circle moment - a small herd reintroduced three decades ago has quietly rebuilt an entire ecosystem, which is exactly the kind of nature-heals-itself story that makes for a great show closer.*

- Just **300 bison** were reintroduced to Oklahoma's tallgrass prairie back in **1993**
- That herd has since grown to roughly **2,700** animals
- The **39,000-acre preserve** now has more wildflowers and new wildlife ponds
- Grazing has also cut down on dry grassland fuel, helping reduce wildfire risk

The Feel-Good Wrap

- 300 animals, three decades, one healed ecosystem - proof a small fix can snowball into something huge.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://en.as.com/latest_news/the-us-reintroduced-bison-to-tallgrass-prairie-in-1993-decades-later-the-herd-has-restored-oklahomas-grassland-ecosystem-f202610-n/?

■ *During California's heat wave, home batteries set a US record by sending 745 MW to the grid in one evening, enough to power every household in San Francisco and San Jose combined at peak demand; 85,000+ Tesla Powerwall owners supplied over 600 MW and were paid for helping stabilize the grid.*

The Angle: *During California's brutal heat wave, regular homeowners with battery packs basically became a backup power plant — and got paid for it. It's a feel-good glimpse at where home energy could be headed everywhere.*

- Home batteries hit a **US record**, sending **745 MW** to California's grid in one evening
- That's enough juice to power **San Francisco and San Jose combined** at peak demand
- Over **85,000 Tesla Powerwall** owners pitched in, supplying more than **600 MW** on their own
- Those homeowners got **paid** for helping keep the grid stable during the heat wave

The Watercooler Wow

- Would you let the power company borrow your home battery for cash — or does that feel like a scam waiting to happen?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://electrek.co/2026/10/14/tesla-powerwall-sunrun-record-745-mw-california-grid-dispatch/

■ *Battery storage is now cheaper than gas peaker plants in all 43 global markets studied, while solar is the cheapest new power source in 43 of 48 markets, strengthening the case for clean energy as gas turbine shortages and fuel volatility drive up fossil backup costs.*

The Angle: *This is the kind of quiet-but-huge shift that doesn't trend for the right reasons - battery storage now undercuts gas peaker plants in every single market studied, which is basically the fossil fuel industry's backup plan losing on cost, not just conscience.*

- Battery storage is now cheaper than **gas peaker plants** in **all 43 global markets** studied.
- **Solar** is the cheapest new power source in **43 of 48 markets** worldwide.
- Gas turbine shortages and fuel price swings are pushing fossil backup power costs **up**, not down.

The Silver Lining

- Clean energy winning on PRICE, not just politics, might be the most convincing argument yet - no lecture required.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.pv-magazine.com/2026/10/12/batteries-beat-gas-peakers-on-cost-globally-but-u-s-faces-trade-headwinds/

■ *DeSantis pledges to legalize Tesla's flying Roadster in Florida*

The Angle: *Only in Florida does a governor publicly bless Elon Musk's wildest claim — a Tesla Roadster that can supposedly fly. It's exactly the kind of absurd, out-there headline that fuels the never-ending "Florida Man" energy and gives hosts an easy runway to riff on Musk hype versus reality.*

- **Ron DeSantis** reportedly pledged to make **Tesla's "flying" Roadster** street (and sky?) legal in **Florida**.
- The claim ties back to **Elon Musk's** long-running tease that the next-gen **Roadster** will have rocket-thruster-assisted flight capability.
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the internet's go-to feed for real headlines that sound fake.

The Script Hits

- Ask listeners: if a flying Tesla actually existed, would you ever trust it over your own two feet?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thenews.com.pk/latest/1420222-desantis-pledges-to-legalize-teslas-flying-roadster-in-florida

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Napoleon Bonaparte has died*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The shock-headline hook (a historical figure's name reading like breaking news) creates an irresistible curiosity gap that drives clicks purely to find out what's actually going on.
The Angle: *This one's pure r/nottheonion gold - a headline so stale it's somehow news again. Perfect two-second laugh for the goodbyes segment before we move on.*

The Eye-Roll Moment

- Somewhere, an editor just discovered the internet has a 200-year delay.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://go.kompas.com/read/2026/10/18/154635474/former-kadiv-hubinter-of-the-national-police-napoleon-bonaparte-passes-away

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■ *Florida DMV hacked after police dept insecurely stored login info | Florida issues alerts after statewide DMV data breach linked to ShinyHunters.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A statewide DMV breach tied to the already-notorious ShinyHunters group affects millions of residents directly, giving it the kind of personal-stakes hook that pushes tech stories into mainstream news cycles.
The Angle: *A massive state driver database breach traces back to one police employee storing login credentials on a personal device — a notorious hacker group called ShinyHunters is now claiming 200,000+ driver records, including an FBI agent's account.*

- Florida's **DAVID** driver database was breached after credentials from a **Plant City Police Department** employee were improperly stored on a **personal electronic device**
- Extortion group **ShinyHunters** claims it stole more than **200,000 driver records** — Florida hasn't confirmed that number
- Hackers claim they also exploited a **password-reset flaw** to access multiple accounts, including one belonging to an **FBI agent**, using predictable security-question answers
- Florida's **Department of Highway Safety and Motor Vehicles (FLHSMV)** has confirmed the breach but disputes parts of the hackers' version of events

The Debate Starter

- One cop's phone, one weak password-reset system, and your driver's license info is in a hacker's hands — whose fault is that, really?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/10/huge-dmv-data-breach-impacted-current-and-former-florida-residents/

■ *Nathan Fielder's Surprise Call From Elizabeth Holmes: 'I Trust You'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Pairing Nathan Fielder's cult-favorite deadpan persona with Elizabeth Holmes, one of the most notorious fraud figures in pop culture, is a bizarre-crossover angle too novel for fans of either to resist sharing.
The Angle: *Nathan Fielder is the king of cringe-comedy weirdness, so when he says convicted Theranos fraudster Elizabeth Holmes rang him up out of nowhere, the internet's demanding details — it's the kind of bizarre celebrity crossover that writes its own headlines.*

- **Elizabeth Holmes** reportedly called comedian **Nathan Fielder** completely out of the blue.
- Her message to him, according to Fielder: **"I trust you."**
- The story's blowing up on **Reddit's r/entertainment** purely on the strength of that one wild detail.

The Head-Scratcher

- What on earth would Elizabeth Holmes want from Nathan Fielder — and would YOU trust her?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wired.com/story/nathan-fielder-tells-us-everything/

■ *Sober house where Presley Gerber died had a previous suspected OD call earlier this year: report https://t.co/C0c9YOp2HG https://t.co/NoSrm5*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A second sober-house OD call before Presley Gerber's death adds a damning new detail to an ongoing celebrity-family tragedy, the kind of accountability angle that fuels follow-on coverage.
The Angle: *Presley Gerber — Cindy Crawford's son — died at a sober living facility, and now reports say that same house had a suspected overdose call earlier this year. That's a real accountability angle: how does a place meant to keep people sober have a track record like that?*

- **Presley Gerber**, son of **Cindy Crawford** and **Rande Gerber**, died at a sober living house, according to the report.
- The same facility reportedly had a **previous suspected overdose call earlier this year**.
- The report raises questions about oversight and safety standards at sober living homes.

The Debate Starter

- If a sober house already had an OD scare on record, should it have been allowed to keep operating?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2112361780378742831

■■ *Trump calls on New Mexico to change its name to 'New America' https://t.co/ik42XqAvku*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A Trump-proposed state renaming is absurd enough to generate the same meme-driven amplification his off-the-wall statements reliably produce, and it's barely been seen yet (26 likes).

The Angle: *The President is pushing to rename an entire U.S. state, and it's the kind of wild, out-of-nowhere proposal that's tailor-made for social media debate and a split-room reaction on air.*

- **Donald Trump** is calling on **New Mexico** to change its name to **'New America'**

The Debate Starter

- Would New Mexicans actually go for this, or is 'New America' dead on arrival?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2112312901876740474

■ *Finland gripped by national broadcaster's puppies live stream https://t.co/Ay9n8XAl6U*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A national broadcaster's puppy livestream capturing an entire country is a pure, low-effort feel-good watch with built-in shareability that cute-animal content reliably overperforms on.
The Angle: *Finland gripped by national broadcaster's puppies live stream https://t.co/Ay9n8XAl6U*

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2112272752107237520

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 1 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test" (Reddit r/nottheonion, banked 2026-10-19)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Kawhi Leonard has fun with Ka'Wine & Dine revival at Raptors media day: 'I can't eat as much'" (Toronto Star (via Google News), banked 2026-09-29)
- "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of 'The Life of a Showgirl,' Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks " (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-29)
- "SteelSeries brings ultra-wideband wireless to gaming mice, chasing lag-free tracking" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-30)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)
- "Banjo-Kazooie PC port developer blasts AI vibe coding as retro gaming fills with low-quality ports" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-07)
- "30 of the Most Fool-Proof (and Romantic) Anniversary Gifts for Him" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "The Atari 800XL is back as a $220 retro machine with a real keyboard, HDMI, and a working cartridge slot" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "'Three Days Of Rain' Broadway Revival With François Arnaud, David Corenswet & Yvonne Strahovski Sets Opening Date, Venue" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea https://t.co/lTSfPsejyB" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-13)
- "London society frets as King Charles skips major high-culture event" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo and Chappell Roan Compete on Game Shows Hosted by David Byrne in the Retro Video for 'Expectations' Remix https://t.co/sBX7jh" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo Taps Chappell Roan (and David Byrne) for Retro 'Expectations' Remix" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Seahawks vs. Broncos, 'Thursday Night Football' game chat and live discussion - Field Gulls" (Field Gulls (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-16)
- "Iron Maiden Announce Surprise 2027 North American Tour" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-18)
- "'Other Desert Cities' Theater Review: Julia Louis-Dreyfus, Ed Harris and Allison Janney Fail to Make a Once-Timely Play Relevant Again" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Says She's Returning for Lena Dunham's 'Girls' Revival: 'I Would Do Anything for Her'" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-19)

- "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-19)

Newly banked this run:

- WHAT THE FRIDAY: "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Rita Wilson Says She’s Returning for Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival: ‘I Would Do Anything for Her’"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-19 11:43 PM